

IDFC FIRST BANK INTERVIEW EXPERIENCE

About the Company:

IDFC FIRST Bank is a leading financial institution in India, formed by the merger of IDFC Bank and Capital First in 2018. The bank focuses on retail banking, corporate banking, and wealth management services. With an emphasis on customer-centric innovation and digital solutions, it has rapidly grown into one of the most trusted private sector banks in India.

Role:Application Engineer

CTC:18.1

Selection Process:

1. Online Test
2. Technical Interview 1
3. Technical Interview 2
4. Managerial Round
- 5.HR Round

Online Test:

- Aptitude MCQs: 10 (15 minutes)
- Technical MCQs: 20 (30 minutes)
- Coding questions: 2 (30 minutes)

Coding Questions:

1.Reverse a String

Input: "hello"

Output: "olleh"

I implemented a simple function using Python slicing (`s[::-1]`) to solve this efficiently.

2.Diagonal Sum in a Spiral Matrix

Given a spiral matrix of size $N \times N$ (where N is odd), calculate the sum of the numbers on both diagonals.

21 22 23 24 25

20 7 8 9 10

19 6 1 2 11

18 5 4 3 12

17 16 15 14 13

Example: For $N = 5$, the spiral looks like above given one,

The sum of diagonals is 101.

Technical Interview 1 (45 mins):

Introductory Question: Self-introduction.

Sliding Window (Banking Use Case):

Question: *The RBI continuously monitors bank accounts. If three consecutive transactions cross a total of ₹800, the account should be blocked for one day. Implement a solution.*

- I explained my sliding window approach:
 - Maintain a window of size 3 over the transaction array.
 - For each window, check if the sum exceeds ₹800.
 - If yes → mark account as blocked.
- I wrote the code, explained it line by line, and discussed time complexity.

Sample Input: [200, 350, 400, 100]

Output: *Blocked* (because $200+350+400 = 950 > 800$).

SQL:

- Query to print the *second largest price* from a table (without using LIMIT or subquery).
- One question on basic GROUP BY usage.
- Asked whether we can use GROUP BY without aggregate functions.
- Asked one basic question to implement stored procedure in PLSQL (To print the second largest price from table after applying discount on it each row as unique discount).

JavaScript:

- Difference between *truthy* and *falsy* values.

Technical Interview 2 (1 Hour 30 Minutes):

This round was a mix of OOPs concepts and in-depth project discussions. The panel expected clear understanding of fundamentals as well as hands-on knowledge of implementation.

• OOPs Concepts (Java-focused):

- Defined the four pillars of OOPs with two examples each:
 - Inheritance (single, multilevel, hierarchical, multiple – and discussed the *diamond problem*).
 - Polymorphism (static/compile-time via method overloading, dynamic/runtime via overriding).
 - Encapsulation (binding data with methods, explained with a class example).
 - Abstraction (using abstract classes and interfaces).

- Explained the difference between interface and abstract class with practical use **cases**.
- **General Project Questions Across All Three Projects:**
 - What was my role in each project?
 - What were the objectives of the projects?
 - What were the major challenges I faced and how I overcame them?
- **DBMS Project (Main Focus – ~40 minutes):**
 - Spent significant time discussing the schema and ER diagram, explained attributes in detail.
 - Asked to draw the frontend of the project on paper.
 - Asked to write folder names and file names of the project.
 - Conceptual questions included:
 - Difference between frontend and backend.
 - What is DBMS vs. Database?
 - What is XAMPP and how was it integrated in the project?
 - How HTML forms work – mechanism behind the onclick submission button.
- **Machine Learning Project:**
 - Asked to define ML to a person with no technical background.
 - Explained how to train and test a model.
 - Discussed the model I used, why I chose it, and differences compared to other models I experimented with.
- **Java Servlet Project:**
 - Questions on What is Java Servlet? and its lifecycle.
 - Since I had used SMTP protocol in the project for sending emails, they asked about how SMTP works.

Managerial Interview: 30 Minutes (Virtual)

This round primarily evaluated my **project execution skills, GitHub knowledge, and communication**.

- The manager asked me to **open GitHub** and explain one of my uploaded projects in detail.
- He then went through **all 6 projects** I had uploaded on GitHub.
- During the discussion, he tested whether I knew how to properly **use GitHub commands and repository management**.
- I was asked to **share my screen** and run the project directly while explaining its workflow.

- The manager also had a **soft copy of my resume**, and he referred to it during the discussion, asking clarifying questions on the listed skills and projects.
- At the end of the round, he asked if I had any questions for him, giving me the chance to interact.

HR Interview: 20–25 Minutes (Virtual)

This round was conversational and focused on **personality, mindset, and career preferences**.

- Began with a short **introduction and family background**.
- Questions asked:
 - *How was your overall experience in the previous rounds?*
 - *If not Engineering, what alternate career path would you choose and why?*
 - Follow-up questions about that chosen career.
- **Scenario-based Question:**
 - *You are playing a cricket match. In one case, your team is winning but you did not perform well. In the second case, your team is losing but you performed really well. Which one would you choose, and why?*

General Tips:

- **Stay confident and calm** – don't put unnecessary pressure on yourself.
- **Communicate naturally** – speak as if you are talking to a friend; this helps reduce nervousness.
- **Maintain composure** – don't be overly afraid; show a balanced level of confidence and positive attitude.
- **Build rapport** – connect with the interviewers by greeting them warmly (e.g., a firm handshake in offline rounds).
- **Answer smartly** – if you don't know a question, try to relate it to relevant topics you are familiar with instead of staying silent.
- **First impression matters** – give a clear, confident, and engaging self-introduction
- **Real life examples**-provide real life examples whenever possible

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Feel free to reach out :)

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